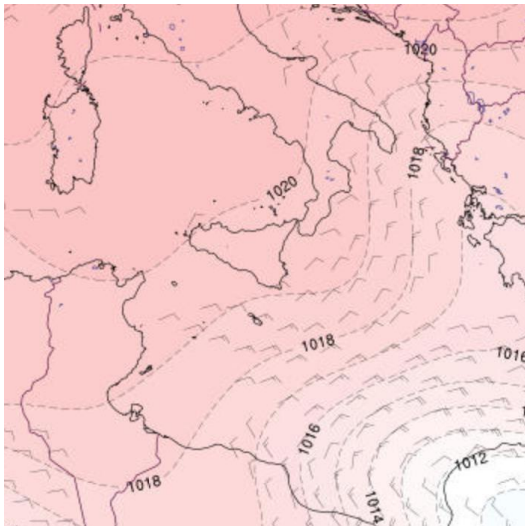


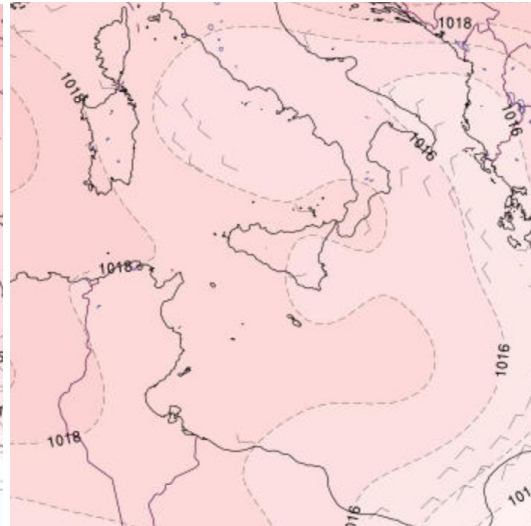
Date: October 20th , 2018
Time: 08:40 AM (06:40 UTC)
Event: Middle Sea Race
Team: POWER PLAY



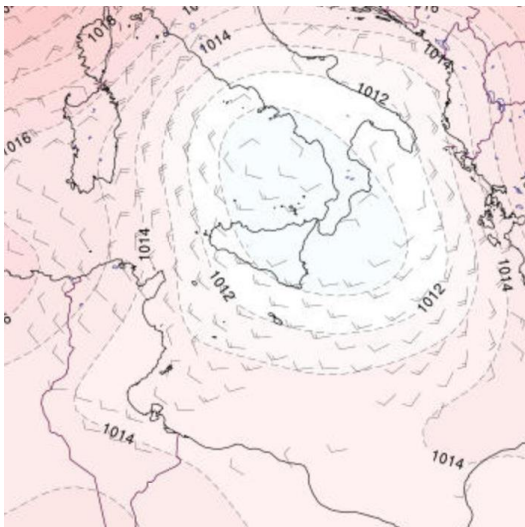
Synopsis: Blocking High covering from Açores to Scandinavia, Low pressures over eastern Libya causing some northerly gradient today. Last model runs show a Low-pressure centre developing on the Tyrrhenian tomorrow night, deepening very quickly on Monday and Tuesday fed by a mid-level Low (and cold air mass) coming from the NE). Every model run this development is changing, though.



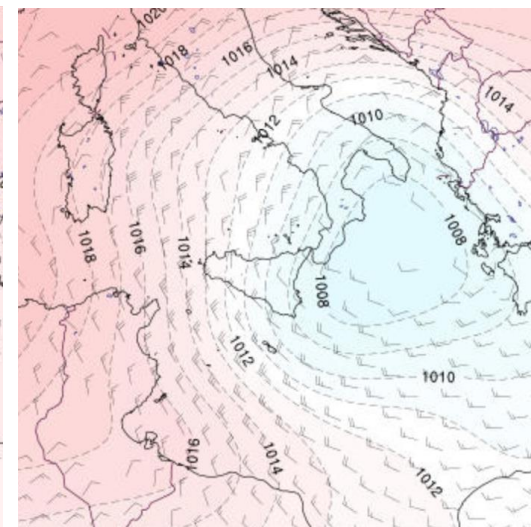
SLP FCST valid 12 utc Sat 20th



SLP FCST valid 12 utc Sun 21st



SLP FCST valid 12 utc Mon 22nd



SLP FCST valid 12 utc Tue 23rd

WARNINGS: Near Gale force winds are possible on Monday; **Gale Force winds are possible on Tuesday 34-40 kts.**

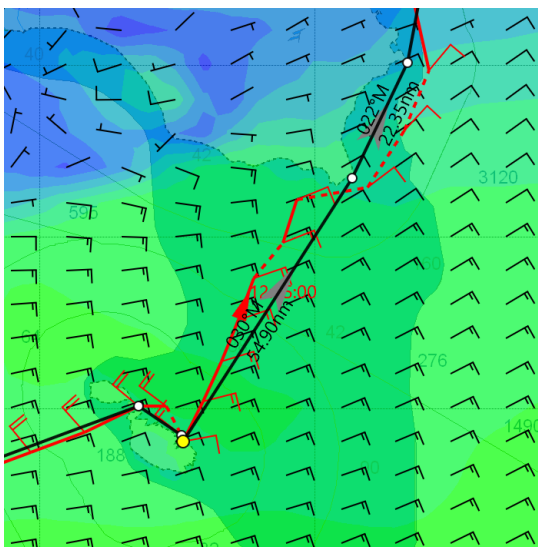
Weather Conditions: There is some instability around all days, partly cloudy with sunny spells but also chance of showers, especially tomorrow Sunday with the convergence of surface winds close to the Strait, and with the wind fronts on Monday. Sea Surface Temperature around 22° C.

Forecast along the course

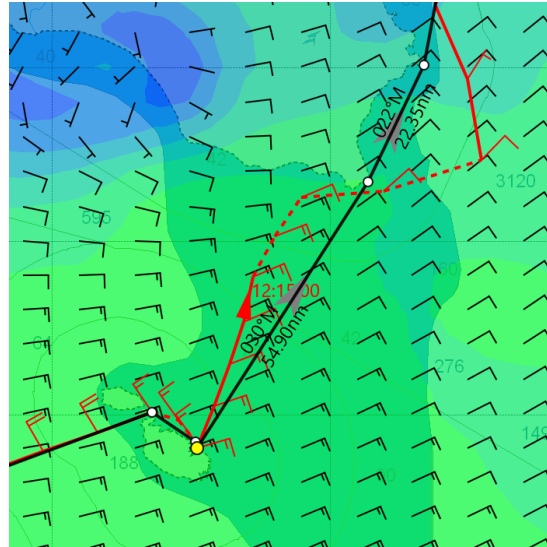
We'll run the routings mainly with Arpege, Lamma 9km up to the Strait, and double checking for the long term with the GFS and EC scenarios.

Malta to Capo Passero and Siracusa

Initial gradient from the NE, 14-16 kts, with a slight left trend and bend around C. Passero (from 060-070 to 040-050 at Capo Passero) and decreasing speed (14-16 kts the first hours, easing to 10-12 at capo Passero). So, the initial strategy should be easy, go left for the trend and bend. The first tack is important, If you point much lower than Capo Passero, play the banana staying on the pressure (I mean do not enter in lighter winds close to land, west of the Cape), and aiming for the Cape (one tack there at the point of max bending).

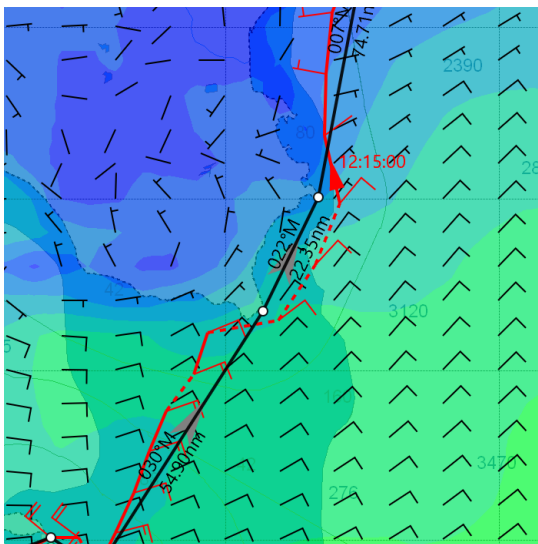


Arpege 14 h

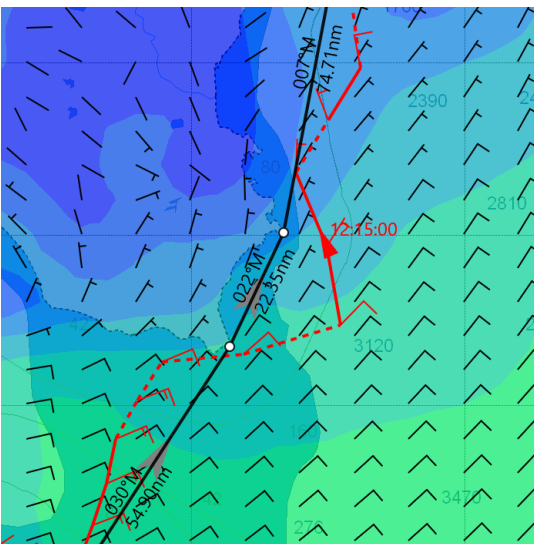


Lamma 14 h

Behind Capo Passero, still some degrees of left bending (can be between 020-040°) and acceleration at the Cape, but closer to Siracusa, however, in the evening/early night, the land cooling drops the wind speed close to it, so there can be more wind offshore. (don't know how expensive your tacks are to play the banana initially)



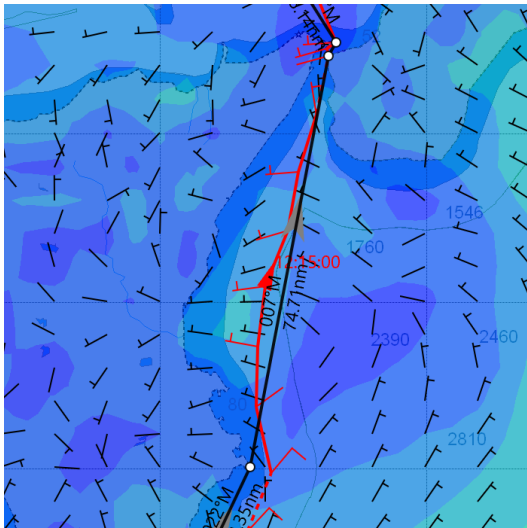
Arpege 21 h



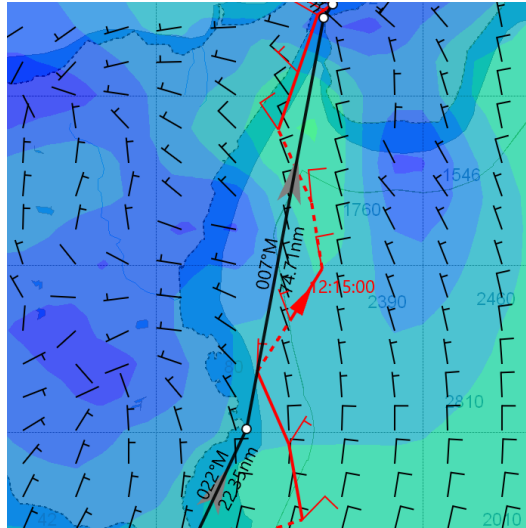
Lamma 21 h

Siracusa to Messina Strait

Both models show Westerly land breeze close to the shore, bending as NW-N offshore, and N exiting from the Strait. Arpege shows weak gradient, a nice land breeze west of the rhumb line, but the opposite for WRF-lamma. It is difficult to know which side pays from the office, because it depends mainly on the gradient wind speed. Sail what you see, if sailing towards the shore you enter in more pressure, land breeze prevails, and vice versa.

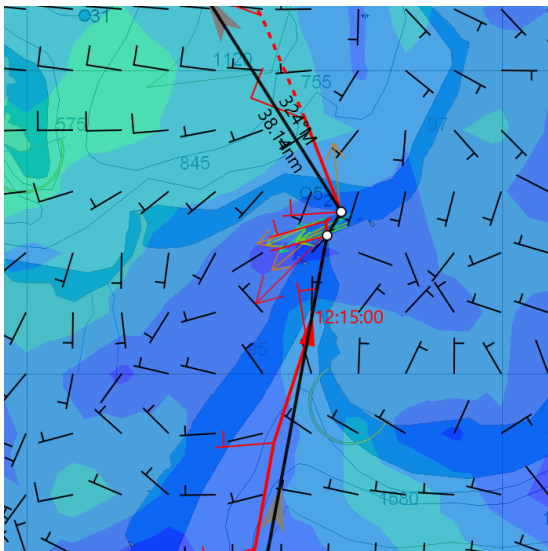


Arpege Sun 02 h

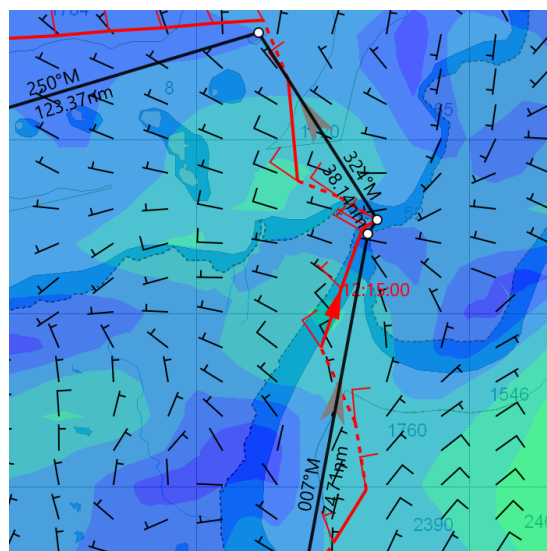


Lamma Sun 02 h

Entering in the Strait, again some differences, Arpege sees a northerly drainage breeze rounding the Italian corner, Lamma the opposite bend around the Sicilian corner. For me you'll have to sail just with the VMG and begin to think on the tide times.



Arpege Sun 08 h



Lamma Sun 08 h

The Tide times will suggest you looking for the stronger or weaker streams when crossing the Strait. In our scenarios full southwards flow for Lamma (10h), almost with the change of tide for Arpege 11-12 h.

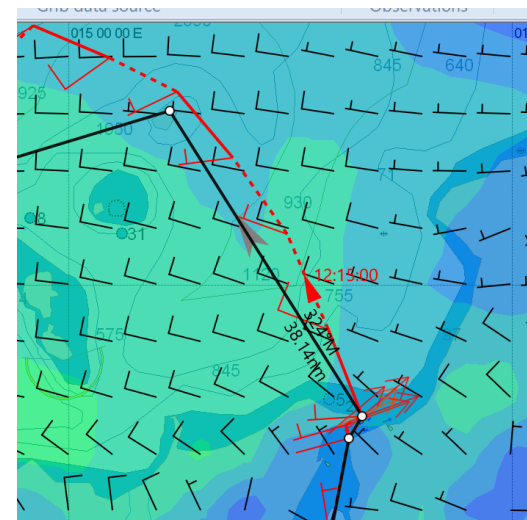
Southwards current (*scendente*) between 0630 h and 1240 h
Northwards current (*montante*) between 1240 and 1840 h. (Sunday 21st)
Southwards current (*scendente*) between 1840 h and 0125 h

Strait to Stromboli

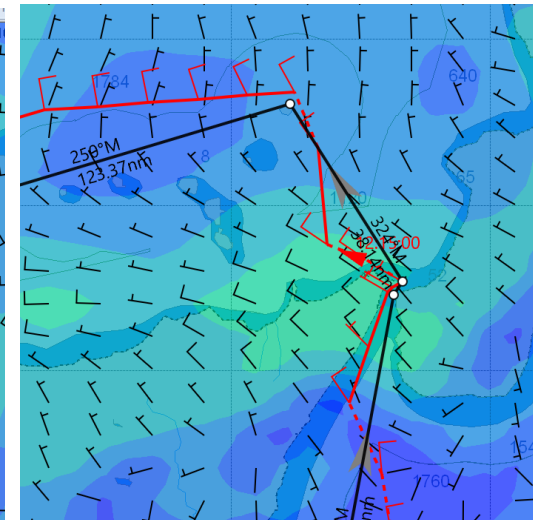
Crossing the Strait tomorrow noon, Arpege shows a NW breeze, slight left trend and more pressure Left (west) but watch out the layline as it can go up to the west.

Lamma routing, a bit earlier, agrees on a stronger breeze along the northern shore (8-10 kts), playing that beat on the Left even if there can be some right trend/bend (4-6 kts on the right side).

Timing at Stromboli around 16-17 h (both).



Arpege 14 h Sunday

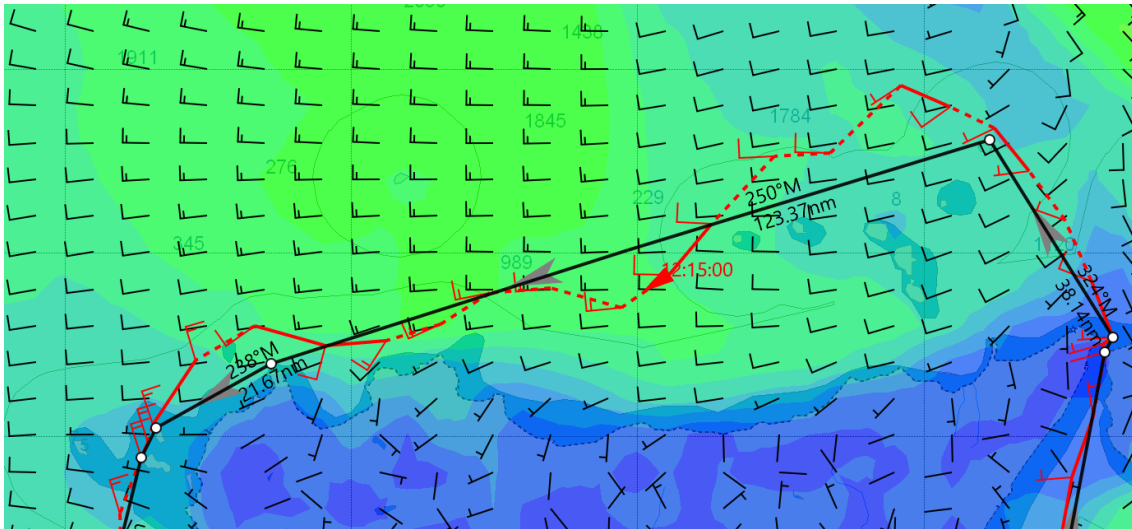


lamma 12 h Sunday

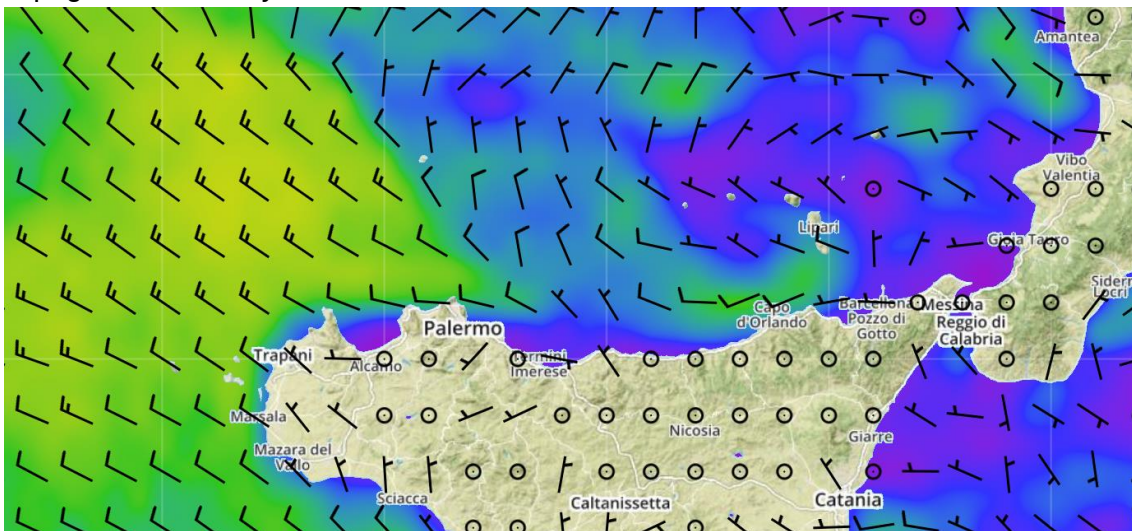
Stromboli to San Vito lo Capo

From this point on, I've discarded Lamma, the synopsis is changing very deeply and quickly and it was the less updated and consistent with the others. Let's base the routing on Arpege, and double check the Big Picture with EC and GFS.

So, let's assume rounding Stromboli around noon. The development of the Low pressure centre on the Tyrrhenian causes a westerly flow along the northern Sicilian coast. Let's see that Arpege (westerly breeze) scenario is more or less consistent with the global models.



Arpege 02 h Monday



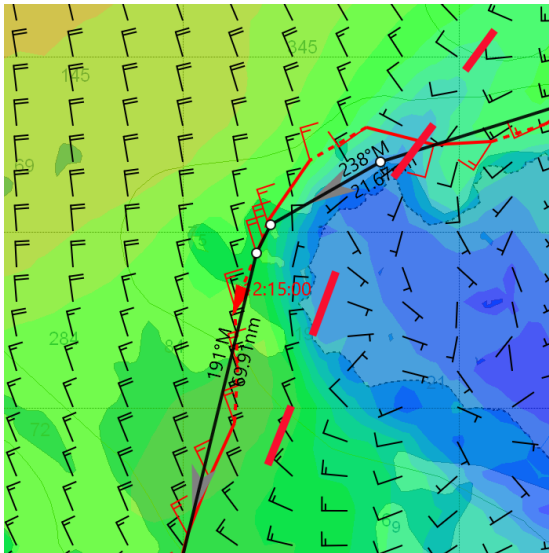
EC 02 h

What we can say at this moment is that it will probably be a beat towards San Vito; play the vmg for a westerly breeze, watch out not too far *north* of the rhumb line (possible less pressure areas), check the model updates often.

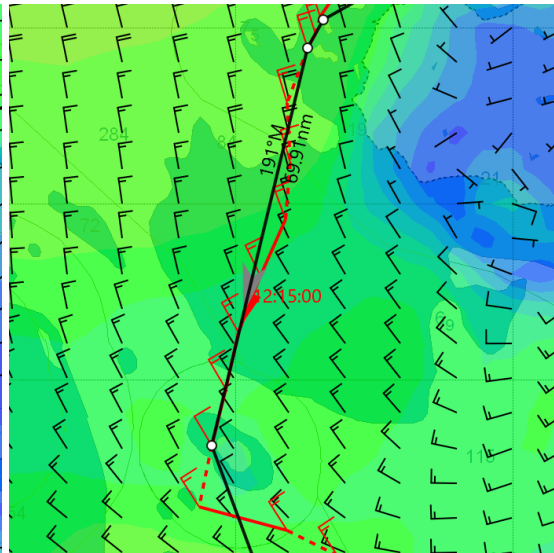
This pattern can be like a prefrontal flow, probably quite variable both in speed and direction. At some stage, the wind front will arrive, shift to N/NW 330-350, possible strong first push (check model gusts as reference).

San Vito to Favignana and Pantelleria

Let's assume reaching San Vito in the early morning 08-09 h, increasing breeze 15-20 kts from 330-350°, Favignana at 9-10 h.

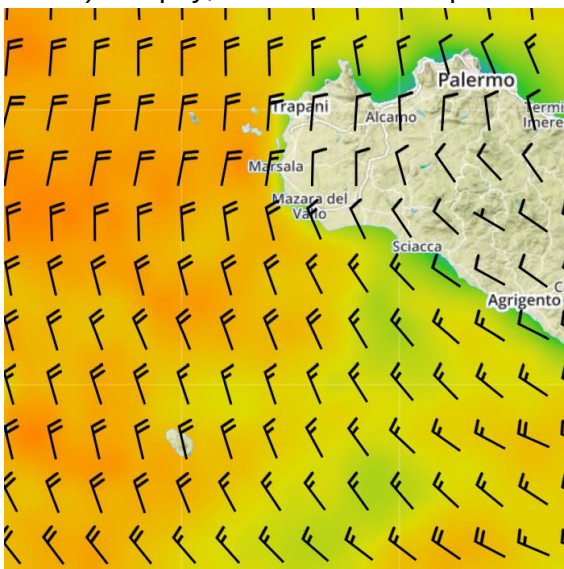


Arpege Monday 10 h



arpege 12 h

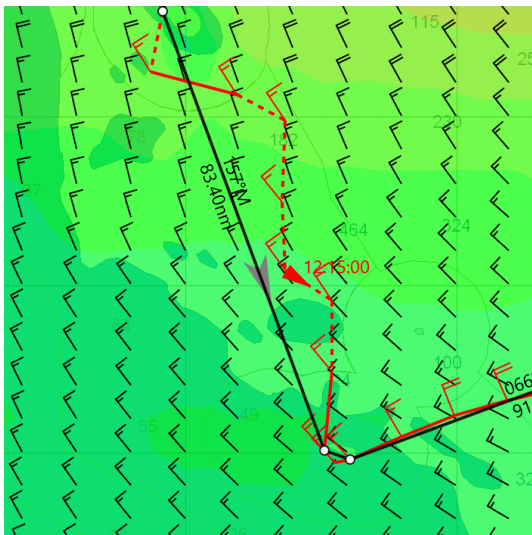
The postfrontal wind can be NW or N, so it is not clear if the leg from favignana to Pantelleria will be a reach or a run. In case it is a run, you can expect a general bend around Sicily, small speed differences, so a route East of the rhumb line (but not far from it) can pay, let's see the European scenario at that time:



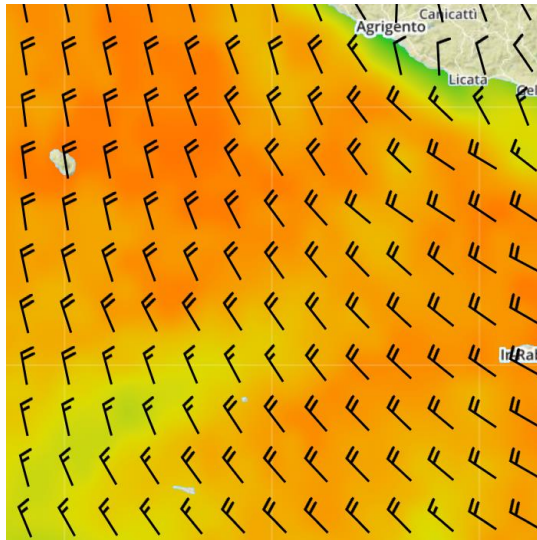
EC Monday 12 h

Pantelleria – Lampedusa - Finish

Same idea for the Pantelleria-Lampedusa leg according to Arpege, some bending suggests an eastern course. However, you'll have to check the models because there can be a Right Trend again to the North with another wind front on Monday afternoon. Beam reach from Lampedusa to Malta.



Arpege Monday 17 h



EC 17 h

Wind can increase to 25-30 kts on Monday afternoon with this new wind front. As said, you shall check the models update as the development of the Low pressure center is very fast. By the moment the strongest breeze is on Tuesday, around 30 kts in the early morning, Gale Force possibly in the morning.